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ENERGY

Proxima Fusion raises \$149M in pursuit of unlimited clean energy

By [Leah Hodgson](#)

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Global VC dealmaking for nuclear fusion startups is on course for a record year, and German startup [Proxima Fusion](#) has just closed Europe's largest round in the space: a €130 million (about \$149 million) Series A.

[Cherry Ventures](#) and [Balderton Capital](#) led the round, with additional investment coming from investors including [UVC Partners](#), [DTCE](#) and [Plural](#). The company has now raised over €185 million in private and public capital, having last raised a €20 million seed round last year. Proxima's valuation was not disclosed.

Founded in 2023 as a spinout from the Max Planck Institute for Plasma Physics, Proxima is working to build a continuous, stable fusion plant using a stellarator, a type of reactor that uses powerful magnets to confine and heat plasma to release massive amounts of energy.

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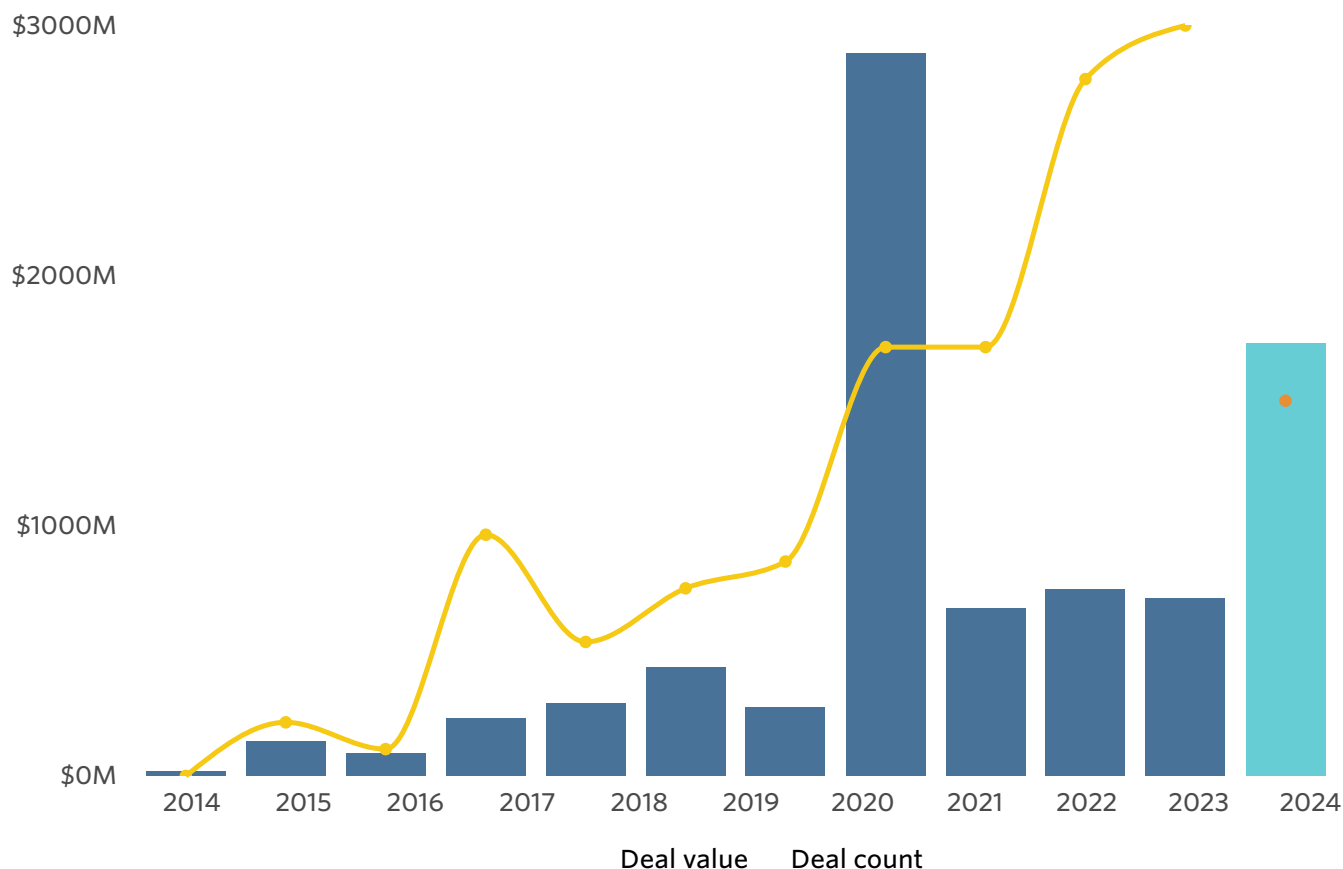
Unlike today's nuclear power, Proxima Fusion's technology produces no long-term radioactive waste and is considered more stable than other nuclear fusion alternatives.

"Stellarators aren't just the most technologically viable approach to fusion energy—they're the power plants of the future, capable of leading Europe into a new era of clean energy," Balderton Capital partner Daniel Waterhouse said.

Earlier this year, the company published peer-reviewed plans for a working fusion power plant that can be operated reliably and continuously. The fresh funding will be used to build its stellarator with the hope of having a demonstration plant by 2031. Proxima will also expand its 80-plus team across Germany, Switzerland and the UK.

Proxima's Series A is just the latest mega-deal to close in the nuclear fusion space this year as investor appetite swells. According to PitchBook data, \$1.7 billion was invested globally across 18 deals in 2025, putting both deal count and value on course to reach new heights.

VC funding for nuclear fusion heats up



Source: PitchBook data
As of June 11, 2025



While Proxima may have closed Europe's largest round in the space, its US-based peers have been raising significantly more in recent years.

California-based [Pacific Fusion](#) secured a \$900 million investment, which closed in March, and Washington-headquartered [Helion](#) announced a \$425 million Series F in January. In Europe, Germany's [Marvel Fusion](#) secured €113 million in March.

Featured image courtesy of Proxima Fusion

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About [Leah Hodgson](#)

Leah Hodgson is a London-based senior reporter for PitchBook, covering the venture capital ecosystem across Europe and the Middle East. Leah, who joined PitchBook in 2018, graduated from the University of Surrey with a BA in international politics with French. She has previously been a radio reporter in France. She later turned to financial journalism, covering the wealth management industry.

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